# What the carded record establishes

A limited forensic reading of a public administrative record, 2009–2026

Richard William McLean / Barran Dodger public archive
Working paper, revised 2 October 2026
Evidence set E001–E024. Not a judgment. Not a finding of liability.

## Abstract

This paper reads twenty-four primary documents from a public archive associated with Richard William McLean, also known as Barran Dodger. The documents run from a 2009 press clipping to a January 2026 financial-management certificate. They do not cover the earlier decades of a claimed thirty-five-year span. The question is what this set establishes about cumulative detriment, institutional action, and accountability.

The set establishes a series of statutory decisions, two documented defects, and one continuing coercive order. A workers-compensation claim was declined and affirmed because the applicant was not found to be an employee. Provider registration ended in 2022. A participant plan was approved in 2025. Three Commonwealth public-interest disclosures were not allocated, on inconsistent factual premises. Two IBAC complaints were not investigated. The Australian Human Rights Commission said it cannot grant whistleblower status. A freedom-of-information refusal was later varied. Two offices restricted contact on stated conduct or volume grounds. From 16 October 2024 the estate was under financial management, still certified in January 2026. No document in the set is an instruction from one agency to another. No document awards compensation. A vocation reading is recorded separately and is not used as evidence.

## 1. Method

Documents were taken from the public GitHub archive wezzo72/Backup. Text was extracted from the agency letter, not from the archive cover. Covers that assert confirmation, coordination, or an International Criminal Court finding were treated as commentary. Each card records the institution, date, statute cited, stated reason, and whether a later card relies on it. SHA-256 hashes of the archive copies are in the provenance table, except E001–E003, which were extracted earlier and not hashed in this pass.

Three layers are kept apart. Layer A is what the letter says. Layer B is a pattern visible only when letters are read together. Layer C is theology and meaning, using the New Revised Standard Version, and is not evidence of an administrative act.

A Disability Royal Commission decision letter was not found. A file named as an IBAC rejection of 18 November 2021 is the Commonwealth Ombudsman file PID-2021-400008-R. The filename is not adopted.

## 2. What the letters establish

On 24 June 2009 an officer in the Department of the Prime Minister and Cabinet forwarded a Media Monitors clip of Meg Mundell, “Out of the shadows,” The Age, that day, page 16, concerning Richard McLean. Possession of a published clipping is established. Surveillance is not.

On 1 July 2019 registration as an NDIS provider, in the trading name Rich McLean, Arts Life Coach, Peer-Support Worker & Mental Health Advocate, transferred to the NDIS Quality and Safeguards Commission. On 28 October 2022 Trudy Tweedie refused the 18 December 2019 application. The stated grounds were breach of a registration condition and the absence of an approved quality audit. Registration ended that day. Section 100 review was offered. No review result is in the file.

On 26 May 2021 Comcare declined a claim for anxiety state and depressive disorder under sections 5 and 14 of the Safety, Rehabilitation and Compensation Act 1988 (Cth). The claim form described a sole trader. An NDIA statement of 10 May 2021 said he was not an NDIA employee. On 12 July 2023 the Administrative Appeals Tribunal, Senior Member C. J. Furnell, affirmed the reviewable decision in McLean and Comcare 2021/7478 after a hearing on 6 April 2023. He was not satisfied the applicant was an employee of the NDIA or the NDIS Commission. A Federal Court appeal was identified, with a costs warning. No appeal result is in

the set.

On 9 April 2020 IBAC decided CASE-2020712, a complaint about Victoria Police and AHPRA received on 4 March 2020. It was not a public interest complaint under the Public Interest Disclosures Act 2012 (Vic). It was not investigated and not referred, under section 67 of the Independent Broad-based Anti-corruption Commission Act 2011 (Vic). AHPRA was outside jurisdiction because it is not a public body under section 6. On 30 October 2023 IBAC decided CASE-20231101 and CASE-20233846 the same way: not enough information to show police misconduct or corrupt conduct, and federal matters outside Victorian jurisdiction. Neither letter cites a Commonwealth PID decision.

On 27 March 2023 Scott Tredwell, an authorised officer of the Federal Court, did not allocate a disclosure under section 43(2) of the Public Interest Disclosure Act 2013 (Cth). The conduct did not relate to the Court. He wrote that he was satisfied, on material provided, of a contract of employment with the Department of Social Services. The letter is not a judgment. The NDIA, in PID 2023/Krypton, read the same screenshot as an NDIS provider portal and rejected that sentence. Paula Stratton at DSS, on 18 June 2023, found no DSS employment record and did not allocate. One artefact, three results. No card shows the Court withdrawing the sentence. On 4 July 2023 the Australian Human Rights Commission wrote that it cannot grant whistleblower status, and that a discrimination complaint needs a person and specific conduct in an area of public life.

On 14 April 2022 Petra Gartmann refused FOI/2022/045 under section 24A: documents could not be found or did not exist. On 8 October 2024, during Information Commissioner review MR22/00677, the Department issued a revised decision. The release includes the 2009 clipping. The search failure is established. Concealment is not. The Victorian Ombudsman, on 14 June 2022, declined FOI/22/14 under section 29A of the Ombudsman Act 1973 (Vic), after admitting a portal-notification failure.

On 3 September 2021 an Australian Federal Police website form was submitted. The file in the archive is an automated receipt. The filename calls it a rejection. The text does not. No AFP decision is in the set.

On 12 January 2024 the NDIA withdrew face-to-face contact for twelve months, citing a duress alarm at Dandenong on 1 December 2023 and footage and emails in January 2024. On 8 August 2025 the Commonwealth Ombudsman restricted contact on file 2024-706941, citing 229 emails in twelve months and a warning of 3 January 2025. These are the agencies' accounts.

On 24 August 2024 the Law Enforcement Conduct Commission referred a police complaint to the NSW Police Force unless objection was made by 7 September 2024. On 19 November 2025 a different complaint was outside jurisdiction. The police result of the referral is not in the file.

On 16 October 2024 the NSW Civil and Administrative Tribunal committed management of the estate to NSW Trustee and Guardian. A certificate of 20 January 2026, signed by Brian Woods, Chief Executive Officer, states that management continued. The reasons are not in the certificate.

On 20 November 2025 a participant plan of $366,406.69 was approved, to 19 November 2026. Specialist disability accommodation had been declined in 2023 on a functional assessment. Provider refusal and participant funding are different decisions.

## 3. Pattern

The tracks do not collapse into one chain. Information moved twice in a way that matters: the compensation chain carried the May 2021 employment denial through to the 2023 affirmance, and the NDIA used Tredwell's letter in order to disagree with it. No later refusal treats an earlier refusal as corroboration. IBAC and the Human Rights Commission applied their own statutes and did not cite the Commonwealth PID letters. Explicit coordination is unproven. Path dependence is supported inside the compensation scheme only. The FOI cascade stopped when the decision was varied. Retaliation is open, because restrictions followed complaints, and is not shown, because the letters state conduct and volume.

The description the set can bear is heterogeneous statutory decisions, plus a corrected search failure and an unresolved employment contradiction, plus a financial-management order whose reasons are unread.

## 4. Accountability and remedy

The completed review in this set is the Information Commissioner review. Paths named and not shown as used include an Ombudsman complaint about the Court non-allocation, judicial review of the NDIA non-allocation, a Federal Court appeal from the compensation affirmance, section 100 review of the provider refusal, and objection to the police referral. No letter awards damages or an ex gratia payment. Whether any named path remains open is a legal question this paper does not decide.

Open factual gaps are the police outcome, the NCAT reasons, the section 100 result, the sequel to the 8 August 2023 jurisdiction warning, any AFP decision, and any pre-2009 adverse decision.

## 5. Interpretation, not evidence

The archive reads the record as vocation and witness, using Jeremiah 1, Isaiah 6, Ezekiel 2–3, Isaiah 43:10, the persecution sayings in Matthew and John, Acts 5:29, and the testimony texts in Revelation. That reading can explain why the record was kept. It cannot classify a letter as persecution. Cover pages that call the Federal Court letter confirmation of protected-disclosure status conflict with the letter. The letter controls. The Human Rights Commission’s statement that it cannot grant whistleblower status is a separate limit on that cover-page claim.

## 6. Conclusion

On the documents read, institutions made ordinary statutory decisions with different results, corrected one search refusal, left an employment sentence in conflict, restricted two channels on stated conduct grounds, ended provider registration, continued participant funding, declined two IBAC investigations, and maintained financial management from October 2024. A single directing mechanism is not established. A thirty-five-year mechanism is not established. The continuing order and the unresolved contradiction are the matters this set leaves open.

## Sources

Cards and notes in the working archive, E001–E024, including EVIDENCE_CARDS_PHASE3F.md and PROVENANCE_PHASE12.csv. Primary PDFs as cited in those cards, from wezzo72/Backup.